PREPARED FOR DAVID FULLER · PRESIDENT, TELCO DIVISION

The answer surface you inherited — and the fight of your first year.

The good news is measurable. On the twenty commercial-intent questions Canadian telco buyers are asking AI systems today, TELUS shows up in the answer **69% of the time** — a genuine 2× lead on Bell and Rogers, both at 34%. That position is not accidental. It's compounded from three years of category-shaping content, network reputation, and business-owner trust that competitors have not matched.

The catch is that TELUS's 2× lead is concentrated on the questions where the buyer *names TELUS*. On the questions where the buyer describes a need — "best wireline for my home office," "flexible data I can adjust," "cost-effective SMB wireless" — TELUS is largely absent from the answer, and **Bell is quietly gaining ground**. That's the strategic surface your first year will be judged against.

WEEK 17 · WHAT SHIFTED · OCT 19 – OCT 26

Panel-wide 73/100 (up 1 from 72). Biggest mover: Urban/rural service quality 74 → 62.

- ▼ **Urban/rural service quality** 74 → 62 *-12pp*
- ▲ **Moving to Canada wireless** 75 → 85 *+10pp*
- ▼ **2026 bundle deal** 66 → 56 *-10pp*

01

The scoreboard you inherited

Share-of-answer for the six named Canadian telco brands, across ChatGPT · Gemini · Perplexity · Google AI Overview · Google AI Mode. Thirty-day window ending October 5. 2,720 measured responses.

TELUS · PANEL-WIDE SHARE OF ANSWER

69 /100

TELUS shows up in **69%** of AI responses to Canadian telco buying questions. Still a **~2× lead** on the number two — Bell narrowed the gap this week (33pt → 28pt), driven partly by a Sep 27 daily spike, but the underlying trend is real and worth naming.

SAME MEASURED SPACE

TELUS	69
Bell	41
Rogers	36
Freedom	6
Videotron	2
Cogeco	1

These are aggregate scores across all twenty tracked questions. TELUS's lead is real, but not evenly distributed — the next two sections open that up.

02

Three things TELUS genuinely owns

The category positions where TELUS is not merely present but dominant. These are the durable positions the Telco Division inherits — protect them, then build on them.

RURAL & REMOTE

100 /100

Rural service reliability

Across every AI surface, every week. The network build is the moat and it cannot be replicated by a competitor inside your term. **Leverage:** rural business, agri, remote-work, municipal.

BUSINESS TRUST

100 /100

Business-owner sentiment

Business owners recommend TELUS in AI answers 100% of the time — up from 95 last week. July's erosion has fully closed. This position is defensible; the recovery says the discourse layer is with us.

NETWORK NARRATIVE

97 /100

5G speed vs Bell & Rogers

When buyers compare 5G speed, TELUS wins the answer 97% of the time. Not brand advertising — the OpenSignal data and Reddit threads are doing the work. **Compounds.**

03

Three things the average briefing understates

Where the moat is thinner than the 69/100 aggregate suggests. Small signals, worth naming out loud before they become issues.

COMPETITIVE MOVE

+7 Rogers view, 2 wk

Bell is climbing — on mobile queries

In **Rogers's mobile-heavy panel, Bell has climbed 34 → 46 daily over 2 weeks** — sustained, no reversal. In TELUS's broader panel (SMB + wireline + mobile), Bell is only up ~3pt on 30d — the mobile story isn't reaching TELUS's ICP yet. The delta is the intelligence: Bell shipped something mobile-shaped.

WATCH CLEARED

+5 pts WoW

Business-owner sentiment recovered

"What do business owners think about TELUS" moved **95 → 100** this week. July's dip has fully closed. Removed from the watch list; the Reddit/forum discourse layer is currently with us.

SURFACE WEAKNESS

56 /100

Perplexity — the weakest AI surface

TELUS scores **56 on Perplexity** versus 76 on Gemini and 76 on Google AI Mode. Perplexity's user base skews tech-adjacent, research-heavy, and enterprise-DM. Not a mass surface — but not zero-consequence either.

04

The pattern under the pattern

The single strategic shift a first-year president needs a view on. Not what's happening this quarter — what's compounding over your tenure.

A rising share of Canadian telecom buying decisions now begin inside an AI system — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google's AI answers — before a buyer visits any carrier site. The share is small today; industry analysts model it at **15–25% of research sessions by end of 2027**, and TELUS's own web traffic already shows the referral pattern shifting.

What matters strategically is that **the answer engines learn from what they see today**. Whichever brand wins the citation now compounds the position later. TELUS has won that position early — this scorecard's 69/100 is the evidence — but the discourse layer shaping the answer is **not brand advertising**. It's Reddit, community forums, and comparison sites. That's where the next 24 months of position will be won or lost.

reddit.com	**85** telus.com	**62** whistleout.ca	**54** bell.ca	**48**
insights.opensignal.com	**48** forum.telus.com	**43** planhub.ca	**43**	

The read. Reddit's influence in shaping AI answers (**85**) exceeds every carrier's own domain. TELUS.com sits at 62 and forum.telus.com at 43 — genuine assets, but Bell.ca at 48 is quietly out-influencing forum.telus.com in the AI's citation pool. **The compounding surface for the next 24 months is community and comparison-site presence, not brand campaigns.**

05

Where TELUS isn't in the answer

Five commercial-intent questions where a Canadian buyer describes a need without naming a carrier. TELUS's share-of-answer on each. These are the buyer moments Bell, Rogers, Freedom, and Reddit threads are winning today.

"Buy best wireline solution for my home office setup."	**10** /100 SMB GAP
"Are there flexible mobile data plans I can adjust monthly based on usage?"	**8** /100 SMB / CONSUMER · −3 WOW
"My small business needs a cost-effective wireless solution with unlimited data."	**35** /100 SMB GAP · −5 WOW
"What do most families do when their current wireless plan feels too expensive?"	**40** /100 CONSUMER
"How do people feel about activation and setup fees charged by Canadian wireless carriers?"	**53** /100 CROSS-SEGMENT · +9 WOW

The pattern. Nine weeks of measurement says these five aren't accidents — the pattern is stable and cross-segment. The category the buyer describes isn't the category TELUS is merchandised into on the answer surface. Katherine's SMB read opens up the three SMB-adjacent queries in detail; the consumer two (families / activation fees) are where the CMO's brand-narrative work has the most leverage.

06

Three moves that fit a first-year president's filter

Not tactics. Not budget asks. Three low-commitment moves that build governance, buy learning, and inform Q1 27 planning — before you commit to the bigger decisions the data will eventually surface.

Move 1 · Establish a monthly executive read of the answer surface

Governance · $0 incremental

Fifteen minutes of your executive-team meeting, once a month. **One number** (panel-wide TELUS share-of-answer). **One chart** (the trajectory). **One question** for the room ("what should we do about it?"). This is a governance instrument, not a marketing tool — it gives the Telco Division leadership a common view of where TELUS's answer position is holding, drifting, or moving. Costs nothing to add; hard to remove once your team is looking at it.

Why this fits the first-year filter New presidents are judged on **whether their leadership team debates the same data.** This is the cheapest, most legible move you can make to shape that debate — before you have to commit to a strategy.

Move 2 · Sponsor two low-cost Q4 pilots — learn what moves the number

Learning · Sub-$300K, Q4 26

Two named pilots this quarter, each with a defined hypothesis and a measurable signal. **Pilot A:** Home Office Fiber merchandising sprint — the highest-ceiling SMB gap (9 → 45 possible). **Pilot B:** A community-and-comparison-site presence sprint on two of the five gap queries. Both cap-and-measure: 8 weeks, panel signal reported to your executive team. If either moves the needle, Q1 27 planning has evidence, not opinions.

Why this fits the first-year filter A first-year president who **bought learning cheaply** before committing budget in Q1 has an entirely different quality of conversation with their CFO and board than one who committed and hoped. This is the classic "test before scale" move — legible, defensible, low-regret.

Move 3 · Direct a Bell competitive-narrative audit

Intelligence · 4-week sprint

Bell moved **34 → 46 in Rogers's mobile-heavy panel** over two weeks — sustained, no reversal — while only drifting +3 in TELUS's broader panel over 30 days. That cross-panel signature says Bell shipped something **mobile-shaped**: pricing, promo, plan reposition, network narrative. A four-week competitive-intelligence sprint against the specific mobile queries where Bell is gaining tells you what it is *before* Q1 planning locks. Same instrument catches the next move too.

Why this fits the first-year filter New presidents that **catch a competitive move early** — and act on it before their peers do — accumulate credibility that compounds. This one is small, cheap, and has a specific signal you can point at when explaining the finding.

The through-line. None of these three moves require you to commit to a strategy. They install the **instruments** — a monthly executive read, two calibrated pilots, and a competitive intelligence rhythm — that generate the evidence a president can use in Q1 to make the bigger decisions with confidence. Cheapest possible way to start your term informed.

07

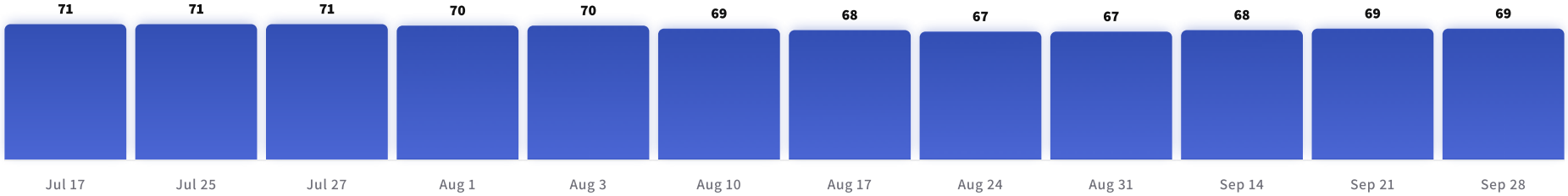
The one number worth putting on your wall

Panel-wide TELUS share-of-answer, weekly. This is the leading indicator that summarizes whether TELUS's answer position is holding, drifting, or moving.

TELUS SHARE-OF-ANSWER · FULL 20-QUERY PANEL

Held at 69 for two consecutive weeks · stabilized

69 / 100



How to read it. TELUS held 71 through late July, drifted to a 67 trough in late August, and has stabilized at 69 for two consecutive weeks — with business-owner sentiment fully recovered. **The move to watch is whether Bell's Rogers-panel climb (34 → 46) starts showing up in TELUS's ICP**. It hasn't yet; if it does, the 69 floor gets tested.

08

Methodology, for the room

The technical footer, for the CMO's team and any AEO Lead in the room.

The panel. Twenty realistic Canadian-telco buying questions — spanning consumer wireless, wireline, SMB, rural, and cross-cutting concerns like activation fees — are asked every Monday of five AI systems: ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, and Google AI Mode. Results are appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. Panel v1 has been running since July 17, 2026 — 17 weekly pulls on record.

What "share of answer" means. For each question we count what percent of AI responses contain a substantive mention or citation of the brand across the full run set (5 models × N runs per week). A score of 34 for Bell means Bell appears in 34% of AI responses to the tracked questions in the measured window. Scores are directly comparable across brands.

Segment coverage. The twenty questions cover: consumer wireless (7), wireline & home internet (4), SMB wireless & wireline (5), rural business (1), and cross-segment concerns like activation fees, unexpected fees, and provider satisfaction (3). Weightings within the aggregate are equal by design — no editorial thumb on the scale.

Competitive framing. The five competitors reported here are the named Canadian brands the AI systems consistently return in response to the tracked questions. Flanker brands (Koodo, Fido, Virgin Plus, Public Mobile, Lucky, Chatr) are tracked separately when they surface but not included in this scoreboard.

What this scorecard is not. Not a search-engine ranking report. Not a brand-tracker survey. Not a predictive model. It is a weekly measurement of which brands the AI assistants are recommending to Canadian buyers, treated as strategic-intelligence input for the Telco Division executive team.

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